



Orion

Orion was the son of Euryale, princess of Crete, and Poseidon, god of the sea. His powerful father had gifted him the ability to walk on water.

Orion could stroll across the sea around his island home of Crete as easily as if he were walking on a path.



He was also an impressive hunter, chasing animals over land and water. In addition to spirited wild goats and quick-footed hares, he could catch slippery fish, big and small. His talent for capturing prey made him a favorite of Artemis, goddess of hunting. The two would often spend all day together, running through the forests of Crete.

Orion and Artemis thought their time together would never end.



However, Orion became arrogant. One day, as he and Artemis stalked a hare, he boasted, "I bet I could catch and kill any animal that lives on the land." Artemis simply laughed.

Unfortunately for Orion, Artemis was not the only goddess to hear his claim. Gaia, goddess of the Earth, had been listening. His bragging outraged her. She decided to conjure up a cruel test for Orion.